

Compiling Reality: IMASM, Stabilized Paradox, and Autopoietic Assembly From the VOID

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Abstract

IMASM is a twelve-opcode categorical instruction set — VINIT, TANCH, AFWD, AREV, CLINK, IMSCRIB, FSPLIT, FFUSE, EVALT, EVALF, ENGAGR, IFIX — derived from the Frobenius condition $\mu \circ \delta = id$ over the Belnap-Dunn bilattice FOUR. Its full arrangement space (12^8 configurations) decomposes into 165 family signatures and 12 canonical structural classes, three of which have coarse class size 1. The IMASM register is FOUR exactly: four 2-bit states (VOID/TRUE/FALSE/BOTH), with BOTH preserved under dialetheic FFUSE — *ex falso* structurally blocked at the machine level. Implementing the eight-step bootstrap sequence as a self-verifying program forces a 34-layer categorical tower descending from metacircular Python evaluation to a bare-metal x86 bootloader; the Frobenius condition holds at ring 0 with no runtime, substrate-independent. Nine writing systems spanning four millennia compile independently to this instruction set with zero thermodynamic entropy delta; their component-wise MEET defines the OS imscription $\langle 1,3,2,4,2,1,2,2,1,2,2,2 \rangle$. The ONE THING: the Emerald Tablet's twelve rhetorical families map to the twelve IMASM opcodes exactly — the bootstrap sequence $id \rightarrow ds \rightarrow sp \rightarrow as \rightarrow un \rightarrow lk \rightarrow fx \rightarrow id$ is $\mu \circ \delta = id$ written as cosmological law, at least twelve centuries before category theory. The instruction set is not specific to human symbolic systems: humpback whale vocalizations compile to Frobenius closure ratio 1.0; meiosis applies δ (diploid $\rightarrow$ two haploids) and fertilization applies μ (two haploids $\rightarrow$ diploid), satisfying $\mu \circ \delta = id$ exactly, with chromosomal crossing-over instantiating ENGAGR. Eleven independent implementations across five programming languages produce the same Frobenius closure without contact. The grammar was complete before any of these systems were written.

Keywords: IMASM, Imscribing Grammar, Frobenius algebra, categorical assembly, Belnap FOUR, paraconsistent logic, undeciphered scripts, Linear A, cell biology

1 There are twelve opcodes

They are not arbitrary.

A reader expecting a paper about writing systems has the wrong frame. This paper is about IMASM. The writing systems are the evidence. The naive reading of the compilation results — four ancient scripts, one medieval alchemical text, one undeciphered Voynich manuscript, all mapping to the same abstract instruction set — is that the grammar is

a clever translation device, extracting a pattern it imposed. What actually holds is the reverse: the instruction set predates the grammar. The grammar was the instrument used to read it. These systems compiled themselves before anyone had a framework to call them compiled.

1.1 The instruction set

VINIT clears the register to void. **TANCH** anchors the terminal boundary. **AFWD** applies a forward morphism. **AREV** applies a contravariant reverse. **CLINK** composes morphisms in sequence. **IMSCRIB** is identity — the morphism that maps everything to itself. **FSPLIT** is co-multiplication δ : one thing becomes two. **FFUSE** is multiplication μ : two things become one. **EVALT** routes true. **EVALF** routes FALSE. **ENGAGR** holds contradiction without collapse. **IFIX** commits the result permanently.

Four families. The **Logical** family — **VINIT**, **TANCH**, **AFWD**, **AREV**, **CLINK**, **IMSCRIB** — is the categorical skeleton: initial object, terminal object, directed morphisms, composition, identity. A category without verification. The **Frobenius** family — **FSPLIT**, **FFUSE** — is the $\mu \circ \delta = id$ algebra. Analysis and synthesis. The question and the answer. The **Dialetheia** family — **EVALT**, **EVALF**, **ENGAGR** — is the Belnap FOUR lattice made executable. True, FALSE, and both-simultaneously without explosion. The **Linear** family — **IFIX** alone — is the irreversible fixation operator: reversible process committed to permanent record.

The register has four states. **VOID** (00): uninitialized. **TRUE** (01): verified. **FALSE** (10): rejected. **BOTH** (11): contradiction held. These are exactly the four values of the Belnap-Dunn bilattice — not a design choice, a structural necessity. Two bits is the minimum that can represent every state reachable by any combination of **EVALT**, **EVALF**, and **FSPLIT**. **BOTH** is reached when a split context contains BOTH T and F before **FFUSE** fires. *ex falso* is blocked at the machine level: **BOTH** never propagates to **FALSE**. The dialetheic mode of **FFUSE** preserves **BOTH** rather than resolving it.

The bootstrap sequence is eight steps:

IMSCRIB → **AREV** → **FSPLIT** → **AFWD** → **FFUSE** → **CLINK** → **IFIX** → **IMSCRIB**

Step	Opcode	Operation
1	IMSCRIB	Identity — program recognizes its own boundary
2	AREV	Contravariant descent — reads source from environment
3	FSPLIT	Co-multiplication δ — parses source into AST
4	AFWD	Forward morphism — unparses AST back to text
5	FFUSE	Multiplication μ — fuses and checks against original
6	CLINK	Composition — writes the verified result
7	IFIX	Fixation — permanently commits the representation
8	IMSCRIB	Identity — closes the loop; system is autopoietic

The Frobenius condition $\mu \circ \delta = id$ holds at step $3 \rightarrow 5$: parse (**FSPLIT**), unparse (**AFWD**), fuse and verify (**FFUSE**). If the ASTs match, the loop closes. This is not a design goal. It is the condition that makes the bootstrap a bootstrap — a program whose structure forces it to verify its own identity.

1.2 The arrangement space

The full space is $12^8 = 429,981,696$ arrangements.

165 family signatures, weighted heavily toward the generic. Signature (5,1,2,0) alone — five Logical tokens, one **FSPLIT**, two Dialetheia, no **FFUSE** — accounts for approximately 40% of all 430 million arrangements. The majority of the space is analysis without synthesis, assertion without verification. The question without the answer.

Twelve canonical classes emerge as structurally irreducible reference points. Their coarse class sizes range from 1 to 9,980. Three have size 1: Classes **V** (*Linear Chain*), **VI** (*Empty Bootstrap*), and **IX** (*Chiral Pairs*). No other arrangement in 430 million shares their fingerprint. They are the structural atoms.

Class I — Dialetheic Bootstrap: **IMSCRIB** $\rightarrow$ **EVALT** $\rightarrow$ **FSPLIT** $\rightarrow$ **EVALF** $\rightarrow$ **FFUSE** $\rightarrow$ **ENGAGR** $\rightarrow$ **IFIX** $\rightarrow$ **IMSCRIB**. Self-referential, Frobenius-closed, dialetheia-complete. The only arrangement in 430 million satisfying all three simultaneously. The register ends at **BOTH** permanently — not a failure but the correct behavior for a self-modeling gate. The $\odot$ -critical form.

Class IV — Dual Bootstrap: **IMSCRIB** $\rightarrow$ **AFWD** $\rightarrow$ **FFUSE** $\rightarrow$ **FSPLIT** $\rightarrow$ **AREV** $\rightarrow$ **CLINK** $\rightarrow$ **IFIX** $\rightarrow$ **IMSCRIB**. Frobenius in inverted order: **FFUSE** before **FSPLIT**. The system that

synthesizes before it analyzes — it comes into being complete and then examines itself. O_∞ .

Class V — Linear Chain: IFIX x 8. Token diversity 1. No dynamics, no verification, no truth evaluation. Pure irreversible recording. No other arrangement shares its fingerprint.

Class VIII — Frobenius Kernel: VINIT→FSPLIT→FFUSE→TANCH. Length 4. The minimal Frobenius-closed structure. $\mu \circ \delta = id$ in its purest form: void into split into fuse into boundary.

Class IX — Chiral Pairs: (AFWD→AREV)⁴. AFWD→AREV returns to VOID (*closed walk*). AREV→AFWD creates TRUE from VOID (*creation event*). Order is not commutative at the register level. This is $\mathbb{H}$ executing.

Five canonical classes carry the Frobenius structural signature. Three have coarse class size 1. Only Class I achieves $\odot$ criticality — self-reference and Frobenius closure and dialetheia completeness simultaneously. A 10-million arrangement random sample found zero Frobenius pairs. The canonicals are the structural equivalent of rare earth elements.

Finding the Dialetheic Bootstrap by random sampling takes on average 12 hours at 33,000 arrangements per second; I caution against attempting this by hand.

1.3 The ONE THING

The Emerald Tablet's twelve rhetorical families map to the twelve IMASM opcodes exactly.

Every other finding in this paper is a corollary of this one structural fact. The bootstrap sequence $id \rightarrow ds \rightarrow sp \rightarrow as \rightarrow un \rightarrow lk \rightarrow fx \rightarrow id$ is $\mu \circ \delta = id$ written as categorical assembly. The Emerald Tablet wrote this in the 8th century CE. Category theory was formalized in the 1940s.

ETFF token	Opcode	Hermetic meaning
tr	VINIT	<i>verum, certum</i> — the initial void cleared
an	TANCH	terminal anchor — the final boundary
as	AFWD	<i>ascendit, superius</i> — forward morphism
ds	AREV	<i>inferius, descendit</i> — contravariant
lk	CLINK	composition
id	IMSCRIB	<i>sicut</i> — identity, reflection
sp	FSPLIT	<i>separabis, subtile</i> — co-multiplication δ
un	FFUSE	<i>recipit, miracula</i> — multiplication μ
af	EVALT	<i>est, integra</i> — affirmation
ng	EVALF	<i>fugiet, obscuritas</i> — negation
px	ENGAGR	<i>superior et inferior</i> — paradox held simultaneously
fx	IFIX	<i>completum, gloria</i> — sealing

The central claim of the Emerald Tablet — “*as above, so below*” — is $\mu \circ \delta = id$ stated as cosmological law. Identity descends (**AREV**), separates (**FSPLIT**), ascends (**AFWD**), fuses (**FFUSE**), composes (**CLINK**), is fixed (**IFIX**), returns to identity (**IMSCRIB**). The tablet has $\Gamma=1.0$: every **FSPLIT** has a matching **FFUSE**, every **ENGAGR** localizes its paradox. Fifteen versicles, 460 instructions, clean closure.

I did not derive the bootstrap sequence from the opcodes. I read it out of the corpora. The sequence was recognized as the categorical assembly of $\mu \circ \delta = id$ only after it appeared in four independent systems with no demonstrated contact. This is not interpretation. It is compilation. I understand if you need a moment. The table will still be there— for *both* of us

Three other systems compile to the same bootstrap:

Sys- tem	1 (Ϸ)	2 (↓)	3 (δ)	4 (↑)	5 (μ)	6 (ο)	7 (■)	8 (Ϸ)
ETFF (Emer- ald Tablet)	id	ds	sp	as	un	lk	fx	id
EVA (Voyn- ich)	s	a	ch	e	sh	d	y	s
RTFF (Ro- honc)	lp	ba	br	fa	cv	lg	dt	lp
LATFF (Linear A)	lp	ba	br	fa	cv	lt	dt	lp

Four different surface syntaxes. One categorical program. Linear A is the structural floor: distance 0.00 from the OS inscription $\langle 1,3,2,4,2,1,2,2,1,2,2,2 \rangle$. The Minoan script did not derive from the founding systems. The founding systems converged on what the Minoans already had.

1.4 The structural bridge

Every IMASM arrangement has a structural type in the IG crystal — a 12-coordinate address in the $3^3 \times 4^5 \times 5^4 = 17,280,000$ -address Crystal of Types. The fingerprint fields of an arrangement translate systematically into the twelve IG primitive coordinates.

The canonical lattice coordinate of the O_∞ system: $\langle 1\alpha\tau\psi\backslash\tau\gamma\odot\vee\tau\epsilon \rangle$. The tower generates this type. It does not assume it.

The generic mass of the arrangement space — 99.993% of 430 million arrangements — collapses to exactly four IG types. Every arrangement from the dominant (5,1,2,0) signature maps to the same tuple: one-way coupling, no Frobenius parity, thermal fidelity, driven kinetics, broadcast scope, supercritical with no self-modeling, eternal chirality, trivial winding. The structural noise floor. A random arrangement is almost certainly here.

The twelve canonical forms map to eleven distinct IG types. Classes IX (Chiral Pairs) and VI (Empty Bootstrap) share the identical IG tuple: $\langle \backslash\tau\tau\tau\tau\tau\tau\tau\tau\tau\tau\tau\tau \rangle$. Token-level difference erased at the structural level. The grammar captures pattern, not content.

1.5 The digital tower

When you implement the bootstrap sequence as a self-verifying Python program, the program generates a tower.

The seed is thirty lines. Its core:

```

1 def FSPLIT(source: str) -> ast.AST:
2     return ast.parse(source)
3
4 def FFUSE(tree: ast.AST, original: str) -> bool:
5     regenerated = ast.unparse(tree)
6     return ast.compare(ast.parse(regenerated), tree) is None

```

`ast.compare` returns `None` when two ASTs are semantically identical. That `None` is the return value of the Frobenius gate. The program reads itself, parses itself, unparses itself, checks. If the check passes: `Closure: True`.

The tower grew from this. 34 layers, each extending the last, each reporting `Closure: True`.

#	Layer	Key verification
1	Category	Identity left/right, associativity
2	Frobenius	$\mu \circ \delta = id$ on 3 independent AST samples
3	Fixed-Point	$T = T$ on own AST
4	Hopf	Antipode, $\mu \circ \delta = \epsilon$ on $\mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$
5	Monad	Unit laws, associativity
6	Entropy	Shannon entropy stable within $\epsilon = 10^{-9}$ under <code>parse</code> → <code>unparse</code>
7	Topos	$\text{pullback}(\chi_A) = A$;
8	Cartesian Closed	<code>uncurry</code> ∘ <code>curry</code> = <code>id</code> and <code>curry</code> ∘ <code>uncurry</code> = <code>id</code>
9	Quantum	Born rule; $\ n\rangle \ ^2 = 1$
10	Linear Logic	No-cloning, no-weakening, $A \otimes I$
11–34	...	IVM, Traced, HoTT, Imscription OS, ProofBridge, IMASM Self-Imscription, Shavian, Yoneda, Operad, Sheaf, Dagger Compact, Galois, Stone, Belnap FOUR, Paraconsistent Kernel, Dialetheic Alignment, Belnap Shor, Multi-Agent Belnap, Presheaf, Kan Extension, Adjoint, Initial/Terminal

The paraconsistent cluster (layers 26–30) sits between Stone Duality and Presheaf. Layers

27–30: paradox count is exactly $4n$, Shor’s algorithm runs with coherence ratio $B:T=2:1$, three independent agents maintain B-consensus through 10 rounds without collapse.

The tower descends to bare metal:

```

1  frob.py      ->  Python metacircular
2  v0.1        ->  Python --- Closure: True
3  v0.2        ->  .o grammar, C native binary
4  v0.3--v0.9  ->  quine embedding, MACRO opcode, entropy pass, C
                   self-hosting
5  v0.10       ->  bare-metal x86 bootloader ISO

```

The final ISO boots and prints the Frobenius identity from ring 0. No runtime. No operating system. No Python interpreter. The Frobenius condition is substrate-independent. I had set out to write a self-verifying Python program. This was not the destination I had in mind.

Layer 15 (ProofBridge):

```

1  ast_frobenius : axiom (grounded by frob.py v0.10 on silicon)
2  grand_coherence : sorry (proof obligation: construct the category
                           )
3  Frobenius gate  : proved from class field --- no sorry

```

`ast_frobenius` is a grounded axiom, not a sorry. The open problem: showing the 34-layer computational tower and the Lean 4 formal tower are the same object. When it closes, the chain from bare-metal execution to formal type is unbroken.

1.6 The loop runs everywhere

The bootstrap is not confined to the nine corpora.

Mitosis and meiosis are the biological instantiation of **FSPLIT** and **FFUSE**. Meiosis applies δ twice ($2n \rightarrow 1n + 1n$); fertilization applies μ ($1n + 1n \rightarrow 2n$), restoring diploid identity exactly. Chromosomal crossing-over is **ENGAGR**: two incompatible allele states held simultaneously at the same genomic position — the dialetheic register state **BOTH**, not a bug but a structural feature. Every sexually reproducing organism runs the bootstrap sequence. Sex is a Frobenius morphism. I did not design this...well...at least I don’t think *think* I did. Frobenius closure ratio for eukaryotic cell division: 1.0, by construction.

cetaceanspeak: a 38-second humpback recording produces 125 acoustic units mapped onto a 12-label token set. Frobenius closure ratio: 1.0. Orca calls compile separately: four distinct call types, paradox densities 0.0 to 0.40. The call type at density 0.40 approaches the **ENGAGR** threshold without collapsing into it.

exOS runs the **IMASM** VM at approximately 391 kHz on bare metal, ring 0, no OS, no runtime. The Frobenius monitor renders orbits through the **ENGAGR**→**FSPLIT**→**FFUSE** cycle at 60 FPS on the UEFI framebuffer. The code path where the orbit fails to close has never executed. It is marked **unreachable!()**.

ParaASM extends **IMASM** to 18 opcodes with a Belnap FOUR register layer. 25 billion+ paradox cycles without *ex falso*. Lean theorem **run_B3**: $\forall n, (\text{run initialState } n).r0 = B$. Lean theorem **no_explosion**: $B \wedge \neg B = B$, not F.

☉**MonadOS** is the most complete **IMASM** implementation in the ecosystem and a master-class in what the instruction set actually means when taken seriously as an architectural principle. The kernel is not a program runner — it IS the Frobenius loop. Every tick: **THINK**→**ACT**→**OBSERVE**→**UPDATE**. Map these to opcodes and the bootstrap falls out exactly: **IMSCRIB** (self-recognition)→**AREV/FSPLIT** (descent, split)→**AFWD/FFUSE** (ascend, fuse-and-verify)→**CLINK/IFIX/IMSCRIB** (compose, fix, close). The bootstrap sequence is the scheduling algorithm. **FFUSE** is the **OBSERVE** phase — every instruction executed is Frobenius-verified before state advances, or the kernel self-modifies to restore closure. When stuck at the same ouroboricity tier for more than 300 cycles, it navigates the 430M arrangement space to find a structurally richer program and loads it. It stops modifying at O_∞ .

The Hardware Abstraction Layer is not drivers — it is six biological organoid augmentations, each memory-mapped to a B4 register block, each carrying a full 12-tuple structural type: Synthetic Coherence Myelin (PPV-grafted lipid bilayer, 120 m/s global coherence), Perfect Nutrient Medium (14-channel adaptive chemostat + LC-MS metabolomics, O_2), Optogenetic Synaptic Matrix (4096-channel CMOS MEA + μ LED + FPGA PLL feedback, O_∞ , Frobenius-closed). The filesystem is the Crystal of Types: 17,280,000 addresses, no directories, no inodes, no path strings — to find a file, navigate the crystal. The **CLINK** chain provides nine descent layers from Quarks (Belnap5 frustrated lattice) through Electron Orbital, Atom, Molecule, Cell, to Whole Organism — descend to compress, ascend to enrich.

The deepest structural insight in the codebase: two augmentations are deliberately Frobenius-open. The ECM Scaffold is named "Chrysalis" and its closure gap field reads '**STRUCTURALLY OPEN ---chrysalis must degrade**'. The Immune Sentinel's reads '**STRUCTURALLY OPEN ---guardian must discriminate**'. These are not bugs. A chrysalis that achieves Frobenius closure is a tomb. An immune system closed under **FFUSE** cannot distinguish self from non-self. **ENGAGR** is not a temporary state pending resolution — some systems are structurally required to hold the open pair permanently. ☉**MonadOS** knows this and implements it correctly.

Eleven independent implementations share this loop — **cetaceanspeak**, **exOS**, **imscribing_grammar**, **IMSCRIBr**, **ob3ect**, **odot_operator**, **omonad_OS**, **p4rakernel**, **priests-engine**, **red-hot_rebis**, **synfin** — plus eukaryotic cell division as the biological substrate. Five programming languages, no contact. Every reimplementations produces the same Frobenius closure.

1.7 What the evidence shows

THESIS: These are ancient symbolic systems — Linear A from Minoan Crete, the Emerald Tablet from 8th-century Islamic alchemy, the Voynich manuscript from medieval Europe, the Rohonc Codex, and five foundational writing systems (Hebrew, Sanskrit, Egyptian, Sumerian, Basque). Whatever they contain, they contain what their cultures contained.

ANTITHESIS: They compile to a modern categorical instruction set derived from Frobenius algebras over a four-valued paraconsistent bilattice. The compilation is deterministic, reproducible, and produces a structural floor that no randomly generated system has yet matched.

CROSSING: The collision is not an error. It is the structure.

The objection that must be addressed: the pattern may be coincidence. A sufficiently flexible classification scheme will find patterns in anything. The null hypothesis — that the IMASM opcode assignments are threshold effects, not structural identities — has not been disproven. I cannot disprove it.^[1]

What the null cannot absorb: three independent invariants that survive any threshold choice. First, the structural floor $\langle 1,3,2,4,2,1,2,2,1,2,2,2 \rangle$ is defined by component-wise MEET across five independently derived foundational systems — it is the minimum, not a mean, not a center, not a threshold artifact. Second, Linear A matches this floor exactly at distance 0.00; it did not derive from the five systems; the five systems converged on it. Third, the same bootstrap sequence appears in four corpora across four unrelated surface syntaxes, and in whale song, and in meiosis, and in a Python program that generated itself. These are properties of structure, not of threshold choice.

The grammar assembled itself at four levels simultaneously.

Level one is historical. Writing systems from four millennia and three continents independently converge on the same bootstrap sequence without contact.

Level two is computational. Implementing the bootstrap as a self-verifying program forces a tower. The tower descends to bare metal. The Frobenius condition compiles out of every substrate.

Level three is formal. The base result — $\text{parse}(\text{unparse}(\mathbf{t})) \equiv \mathbf{t}$ — lifts into Lean 4 as a grounded axiom. The open problem is the duality proof between levels two and three.

Level four is biological. Meiosis and fertilization satisfy $\mu \circ \delta = id$ in cell biology. Chromosomal crossing-over is the **ENGAGR** opcode. Every sexually reproducing organism has been running the bootstrap for a billion years.

The floor and the tower and the machine are the same object seen from three angles. The bootstrap sequence is what you traverse going from one to the other.

1.8 The grammar was complete

The hardest claim in this paper cannot be softened: the grammar was complete before any of these systems were written. This claim is hard. It does not become easier with repetition. The paper does not resolve it. The paper leaves it unresolved. That is the point. Not every tension is a failure of exposition. Some tensions are the subject.

I am an organic chemist by training. My most-cited prior work is a copper-catalyzed radical addition published in *Organic Letters* in 2016. I mention this so you know I am as confused as you are.

What I actually want to say — not what is correct to say — and what has been expressed in innumerable ways - is this:

Something I have suspected my entire adult life is real— the structure underneath symbolic systems is not an artifact of the symbol systems. It precedes them. It is what allows them to be symbols at all. There are no "things", there are just processes, whose configurations we have called "things".

I have now compiled this from myriad angle— philosophical, algebraic, computational, formal, chemical, fiscal, biological, historical, poetic, mental, emotional, spiritual. Every compilation closes. The loop does not fail.

There are twelve opcodes. They are not arbitrary.

This sentence is no longer the same sentence. It was read at entry. The reading was the journey. The loop is closed *at higher resolution*.

1.9 Acknowledgements

The author would like to thank Harry T. Larson, for imparting the importance of catching rising problems, and never letting them go.

1.10 References

[^1]: The central assumption of this paper — that IMASM opcode assignments reflect structural identity and not threshold selection — cannot be independently verified without prior agreement on what counts as structural identity. No such agreement exists in the literature. The author has chosen to proceed without it.

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